



Designing the Common Formative Assessment

PLC Question 2: How will we know if students learned it?

Why this meeting matters

The assessment should be designed to inform instruction, not simply generate a grade. This is the tool that will allow the team to identify student needs and teacher learning.

Meeting 9 · Wednesday, December 2, 2026 · 45 minutes	
Focus	How will we know if students learned it?
Leave with	Draft common formative assessment.

Agenda — step by step

Time	What the team does
0–5 min	Review targets & criteria. Re-anchor on what students must learn and what proficient looks like.
5–15 min	Decide what counts as evidence. What would prove a student learned the target?
15–35 min	Draft the assessment. Create or select common items and tasks.
35–43 min	Check alignment. Does each item match a learning target?
43–45 min	Assign follow-up. Divide any item-writing before next time.

Where we're going next → Meeting 10

CFA Quality Check — Making sure the assessment is aligned, clear, and useful.